GinCol Lab · Aula

Student worksheet

Contemporary World History · 1st year of Bachillerato · The historian's craft · Class 4 of 6 · With Tristán

1789: did everything change for everyone?

Class video: https://youtu.be/jcWJABA81hM

The code leads to the video.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Before you start: your bet

In August 1789, the French National Assembly passed a decree that begins like this: "The National Assembly entirely destroys the feudal regime." **A peasant, in 1790: does he stop paying his lord?** Tick one and explain why in one sentence.

1. Yes, he pays nothing any more.

2. He still owes what he pays for the land.

3. He pays more than before.

At the end of the class. What answer does the law give? And what did many peasants do?

While you watch the video

1. The decree begins by saying that it "entirely destroys the feudal regime". What does it say next, in the same article?

2. At what price could a charge be redeemed, according to the law of May 1790? When were they all abolished without compensation?

3. The announcement, the law and the people: when did each one change?

4. Between 1789 and 1848, what changes fast and what changes slowly?

5. Article 6 of the Declaration speaks of "all citizens". Who was left out in Sieyès's draft?

6. Write down the four questions of significance.

The vote, out of every hundred

People who could vote in France, out of every 100 inhabitants (Meuriot, 1916; ordinance of 1944).

Year	Who could vote	Out of 100
1791	Men aged 25 or over who pay a small tax; they vote in two steps	
1792	Men aged 21 or over, except servants	
1817	Only those who pay 300 francs in direct taxes	

Year	Who could vote	Out of 100
1848	All men aged 21 or over	
1944	An ordinance: "women are voters and eligible for election under the same conditions as men"	—

1. Fill in the last column with the figures from the video.

2. By the criterion "how many people could vote", did it go forwards or backwards from 1791 to 1817?

3. **Change the criterion.** In 1791, the voters only chose some 43,800 electors, and it was these electors who elected the deputies: fewer than 2 in every 1,000 inhabitants. In 1817, some 102,000 people elected the deputies directly: about 3 in every 1,000. By the criterion "how many people elected the deputies", did it go forwards or backwards? What does this teach you about the words "step backwards"?

Fast, slow or hardly at all?

Mark **F** (changed fast), **S** (changed, but slowly), **H** (hardly changed) or **B** (changed backwards; say by what criterion).

1. On the night of 4 August 1789, the deputies give up the privileges.

2. What the peasant pays the lord for the land, from 1789 to 1793.

3. France's regime, from 1791 to 1848.

4. How many French people live in the countryside, from 1789 to 1846.

5. Slavery in Guadeloupe, in 1802.

6. The metre, from the law of 1795 to becoming the only measure allowed in France.

Which of these changes do you think was the most significant for most French people in 1789? Reason it out with one of the four questions of significance.

Practice

1. **An oral source.** Ask an older person in your family, with their permission, what a day of theirs was like when they were your age. Write down three things that have changed and three that are the same. Has any got worse? By what criterion, and for whom?

2. **Spain.** Women voted for the first time in a general election in 1933. And from the February 1936 elections to the June 1977 ones, there were no free general elections, neither for women nor for men. Draw that timeline, mark where it changed backwards and say by what criterion. Keep the fact, the criterion and the judgement separate.

3. **The significance of the Wall.** Apply the four questions of significance to the opening of the Berlin Wall (class 3). Is it as significant as 1789? Say where you are looking at it from.

Keep thinking

In a hundred years' time, a historian writes about our era. Of everything you have lived through, which event would they choose, and by what criterion? Write your answer using one of the four questions, and the

best reason someone might give for choosing a different event.

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